

CHEATSHEET · QUICK REFERENCE

Lab 23 — OS and Application Hardening

Run the Lynis scan-fix-rescan loop, minimise services/ports/packages, harden nginx, apply HIDS and MAC, and complete the hardware-hardening checklist.

Scan and minimise

```
lynis audit system --quick
Baseline hardening scan (index 0-100)

systemctl disable --now cups bluetooth avahi-daemon
Disable unused services

ufw default deny incoming ; ufw allow 22/tcp ; ufw --force enable
Close unneeded ports

apt purge -y telnet ftp rsh-client ; apt autoremove -y
Package minimisation
```

App hardening + HIDS/MAC

```
add_header X-Frame-Options DENY;
nginx clickjacking header

server_tokens off;
Hide version banner

aideinit -y -f
Build the AIDE file-integrity baseline

chkrootkit | head -20
Anti-rootkit scan

aa-enforce /etc/apparmor.d/usr.sbin.nginx
Enforce a MAC profile
```

Hardware hardening checklist

Action	Why
BIOS/UEFI supervisor password	Stop boot-order tampering
Boot order: internal disk only	Block USB/PXE rogue OS
Disable unused USB ports	Block rogue devices
Disable Wi-Fi/Bluetooth radios	Reduce radio attack surface
Disable PXE/WoL if unused	Block pre-boot exploitation